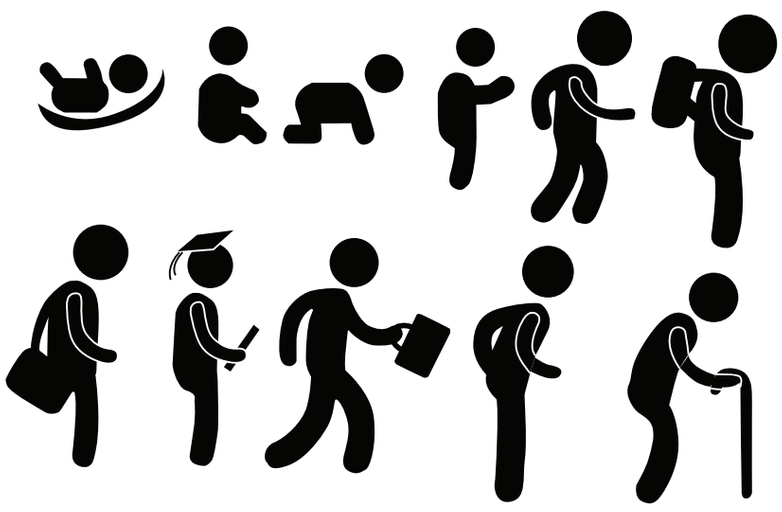
Chapter 2 Human Development and its Challenges

Learning Objectives

This chapter will enable the students to

- Know about the various stages in life span, its meaning and subdivisions
- Gain knowledge about the characteristics of each stage in life span
- Understand the physical, social, emotional and cognitive changes in each stage
- Know the challenges faced by children with special needs
- Understand the challenges in adulthood and old age

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2.1 INTRODUCTION

The study of human development can be traced back to the 18th century. The first effort towards the study of the child based on direct observations were initiated by Darwin (1809-82) and Preyer (1841-97). They maintained careful notes on the development and behaviour of individual children over a period of years. Stanley Hall (1844-1924) in United States of America, and Alfred Binet (1857- 1911) in France carried out scientific investigation to understand the causes of human behaviour.

Hall studied the concepts of children and published his finding in the book "*The content of Childrens mind*" in 1883. The first intelligence scale was published in 1905 by Binet. A discipline

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